Name:
ID:

Section:.....

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University
Faculty of Language Studies

Arab Open University

FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

EL122
Writing Research

MTA Exam
Main – All Branches
Makeup - KSA

Fall Semester 2025-2026
Date: 19 Nov. 2025
9:30 – 11:30

Number of Exam Pages: 6 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 1.5 hours

Instructions

ake sure you complete all the necessary information such as your name, your registration nu
your section number on this cover sheet
is exam has 3 parts
swers must be written neatly and legibly
end some time at the end to revise your spelling and grammar

This exam consists three parts. Please check the following table for grade computat

Part A	/15	
Part B	/8	
Part C	/7	
Total	/30	

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PART A: [15 Points]

Read the following passage and respond to the prompts that follow it:

In recent years, artificial intelligence has shifted from a distant dream to a transformative force shaping nearly every aspect of modern life. From healthcare diagnostics to language translation and automated transportation, AI systems are increasingly performing tasks once limited to human expertise. While these advancements promise efficiency and innovation, they also raise concerns about data privacy, job displacement, and ethical accountability.

Governments and industries around the world are now debating how best to regulate AI without hindering its potential. Some advocate for stricter guidelines to prevent misuse, while others argue that too much control could slow progress. The future of AI will depend on finding a balance between innovation and responsibility—ensuring that technology serves humanity rather than replaces it.

— Sami Al-Faraj, "The Rise of Artificial Intelligence and the Question of Control"

1. What is the topic of this passage? [2 Points]

_____

2. Write a suitable title for the passage. [1 Point]

_____

3. Write a research question for the passage. [2 Points]

_____

_____

4. Write a one-sentence summary of this passage. [3 Points]

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5. Write a response to this passage. [4 Points]

6. Paraphrase the following sentence from the passage: "The future of AI will depend on finding a balance between innovation and responsibility—ensuring that technology serves humanity rather than replaces it." [3 Points]

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PART B: [8 Points]

1. Pick one of the following topics and write a rough outline for a potential research essay. [6 Points]

- **The influence of AI on education.**
- **The impact of social media algorithms on mental health.**
- **The future of remote work after the pandemic.**

_____

_____

_____

_____

2. Write a thesis statement for the outline that you developed in the previous question. [2 Points]

_____

_____

PART C: [7 Points]

Respond to the following prompts:

1. **For each thesis statement, identify the problem and rewrite the thesis statement to be more effective. [2 Points Each]**

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a. Voltaire was a good writer.

Problem:

_____

_____

Revised Thesis:

_____

_____

b. Online learning is useful for some students.

Problem:

_____

_____

Revised Thesis:

_____

_____

2. Here is an original sentence and two paraphrases of it. For each paraphrase, decide if it meets all three criteria for a good paraphrase. If there is a problem, identify it and then rewrite the paraphrase to make it more effective. [3 points]

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Original:

"Social media has become a primary source of news, but its speed and reach often allow misinformation to spread more rapidly than verified facts."

—Chen, Digital Society (2021)

Paraphrase 1:

Chen (2021) notes that social media helps people access news instantly, yet false information often spreads faster than accurate reports.

Does the paraphrase meet all three criteria? Yes / No [0.5 points]

If no, what is the problem? _____[0.5 points]

Rewrite to improve: _____

(student should indicate if no rewriting is needed). [0.5 points]

Paraphrase 2:

Social media is a good thing because it lets everyone share the truth quickly.

Does the paraphrase meet all three criteria? Yes / No [0.5 points]

If no, what is the problem? _____[0.5 points]

Rewrite to improve: _____

(student should indicate if no rewriting is needed). [0.5 points]

End of Exam

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